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INTERIM REVISION OF
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INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PENHOLDERS, WRITING

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers penholders for general office use.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types. The penholders shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1 and 6.2).

Type I - Cork grip, plastic body.
Type II - Plastic grip and body (crowquill).
Type III - Plastic grip and body.

1.2.2 Colors. Penholders, types I and III, shall be furnished in black or red, as specified (see 6.1). Type II shall be furnished in black.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

FSC 7510

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Material used shall be of the best quality in accordance with standard commercial practice and shall be as specified herein.

3.1.1 Plastic. Plastic shall retain its design contours without warping, crazing, cracking, softening, or discoloring in normal service and storage and shall be nonflammable, flame resistant, or slow burning when tested as specified in 4.2.4.3. The surface shall be free from cold bonds, delaminations, porosity, warpage, checks, cracks, chipped edges, blisters, and scratches, and shall present a smooth, uniform surface to eye and touch.

3.1.2 Cork. Cork in grips shall be of good quality and shall remain firm in normal service and storage.

3.2 Design and construction. The penholder staff shall be round and symmetrically tapered and shall be designed so that pen points are held securely in position by the pen-point holding device. The penholder shall have sufficient strength to withstand the test in 4.2.4.2 without damage.

3.2.1 Type I, cork grip, plastic body. The penholder shall be not less than 6-3/4 inches long. The tapering plastic staff shall be one continuous piece and shall be properly recessed at the grip end to assure tight fitting of the cork grip. The cork grip shall be not less than 1-3/16 inches long and not less than 7/16-inch in diameter at the grip end. The grip shall taper symmetrically with the staff and shall not be smaller in diameter than the adjacent part of the staff. The grip shall not separate from the penholder proper when tested in accordance with 4.2.4.1. The penholder shall be designed to accommodate standard-size commercial pen points.

3.2.2 Type II, plastic grip and body (crowquill). The penholder shall be not less than 4-1/2 inches long. The tapering plastic staff shall be one continuous piece not less than 5/16-inch at its maximum diameter and may taper slightly near grip end to provide a proper balance and comfortable finger grip. The penholder shall be designed to accommodate crowquill pen points with a nominal shank diameter 1/8-inch.

3.2.3 Type III, plastic grip and body. The penholder shall be not less than 5-3/4 inches long. The tapering plastic staff shall be one continuous piece not less than 3/8-inch in diameter at the grip end. The penholder shall be designed to accommodate standard-size commercial pen points.

3.3 Finish. Penholders shall have a smooth, even finish in accordance with standard commercial practice. Penholders shall have a comfortable finger grip.

3.4 Identification marking. Penholders shall be legibly marked so that the source of manufacture can be readily determined.

3.5 Workmanship. Penholders shall be free from defects which might affect their appearance or serviceability.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling and inspection.

4.2.1 Lot. For purposes of sampling for inspection, a lot shall consist of all penholders offered for acceptance at one time.

4.2.2 Visual examination. Examine sample penholders for defects listed in table I. Sampling for visual examination shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-3, with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units. The sample unit shall be one penholder.

Table I. Classification of defects.

Examine	Defects
Material	Plastic not as specified in 3.1.1. Cork not as specified in 3.1.2.
Design and construction	Staff not round; not symmetrically tapered; not one continuous piece. Staff not provided with an efficient pen-point holding device (does not hold pen points securely in position). Cork grips smaller in diameter than the adjacent part of the staff; not tight-fitting. Dimensions not as specified.
Finish	Not as specified in 3.3.
Identification marking	Not as specified in 3.4.
Workmanship	Not as specified in 3.5.

4.2.3 Preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Table II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and (interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or distortion of container.
Contents (exterior and interior container)	Number per container is more or less than required. Net weight exceeds requirements.

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4.2.4 Tests. Sample penholders shall be subjected to the following tests. Sampling for tests shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-2, with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units. The sample unit shall be one penholder.

4.2.4.1 Type I. Attach a suitable holding device for application of an even pulling force to the cork grip, about 3/8-inch from grip end, and secure penholder proper to a scale (or other suitable recording device). Gradually apply a pull of 3 pounds to the grip and check for compliance with 3.2.1.

4.2.4.2 Strength test. A sheet of paper shall be placed on a platform scale. Insert a standard commercial, corrosion-resisting, steel pen point in types I and III penholders and a crowquill pen point in type II penholder. The sample penholder shall be held between 1-1/4 and 1-1/2 inches from the grip end. Hold pen point to paper in a normal writing position and at an angle of 50° from the horizontal without the hand touching the paper. Apply a force of 3 pounds gradually and uniformly in order to avoid variations and shock. Immediately release after 5 seconds of full pressure and examine for compliance with 3.2. Disregard any bending or distortion of the pen point.

4.2.4.3 Flammability test for plastic. A draft shield shall be used to reduce air current effects. Remove cork grip from type I penholder. Hold the specimen horizontally within the shield above a Bunsen burner having a 1- to 1-1/4 inch blue flame just touching the grip end of the staff until the specimen ignites, or for a period not over 30 seconds. Remove the flame. If the specimen will not support combustion, it is nonflammable. If the specimen burns when in contact with the flame but will not continue to burn when the flame is removed, it is flame resistant. If the specimen continues to burn at a rate of less than 2.5 inches per minute, it is slow burning. If the specimen bursts into flame immediately, it is to be considered as not meeting the requirements of this specification. This test shall assure compliance with 3.1.1.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. Twelve (12) penholders of like description shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665 or PPP-B-676.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1) 3 unit packages of penholders of like description shall be intermediate packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665 or PPP-B-676.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Unit packaging. Twelve (12) penholders of like description shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665 or PPP-B-676.

5.1.2.2 Intermediate packaging. Three (3) unit packages of penholders of like description shall be intermediate packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-665, PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676.

5.1.3 Level C. The penholders shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Penholders of like description in quantities as specified (see 6.1) shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, type CF, variety SW. The box shall be closed, waterproof sealed, and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. The gross weight shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Thirty-six (36) intermediate packages of penholders of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, type CF, variety SW. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The penholders shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

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5.3 Standard Packaging (Civil agencies). The standard packaging and packing for civil agencies shall be as specified in 5.1.2 and 5.2.2, respectively.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES.

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Color required (see 1.2.2).
(d) Quantities of unit packages in intermediate package (see 5.1.1.2).
(e) Quantities of intermediate packages in shipping container (see 5.2.1).
(f) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.2 Change of classification of types. This specification includes a change in the classification of penholder types designated in previous documents. The type II and type IV penholders of previous documents are not included in this specification. The type II penholder, specified herein, is a new entry. Types I and III penholders, specified herein, are similar to types I and III in the previous document GGG-P-181c, except that the type definitions have been changed, reflecting changes in materials used.

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